

WEB SPIDERS



Spiders are afraid of us, so the only signs we tend to see of them are the silken webs they spin to catch their prey. Not all spiders make webs, but the ones that do, like this funnel-web spider, are good at recycling. When its web gets damaged, the spider eats it, digests the silk, then uses it to spin another one.



Up, up and away

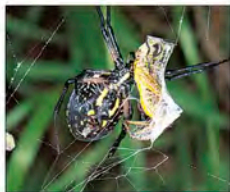
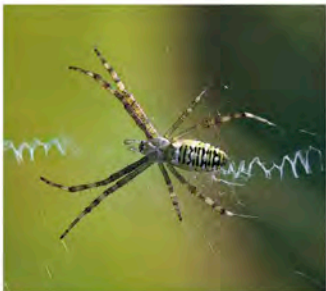
When baby spiders—called spiderlings—want to travel long distances they take to the air. They do not have wings but they are still able to fly. They produce a piece of silk and use it like a balloon.



The spiderling suspends itself from a long line.

It makes a loop, which is slowly drawn up by the breeze.

When it's ready to take off, it cuts itself free.



I'll eat you later

If a spider catches a tasty insect, but is not hungry, it poisons it but does not kill it. Then it wraps it in silk and keeps it for later.

Spiders do not have bones. Their head and thorax are covered by a hardened shield.

Silk is produced through the spinnerets on the end of the spider's abdomen. Spiders use their legs to pull out the silk.

The saclike abdomen contains the heart, lungs, silk glands, and the reproductive parts.

Fatal fascination

Scientists think that insects are attracted to spiderwebs because patterns in the webs reflect ultraviolet light. Unlike us, insects see ultraviolet light and use it to find food.

